Care of Infants (2 months to 5 years)

It includes

- Management of diarrhoea, acute respiratory infections (pneumonia) malaria, measles, acute ear infection, malnutrition and anemia
- Recognition of illness in children and management/referral
- Prevention and management of Iron and Vitamin A deficiency
- Counseling on feeding for all children below 2 years
- Counseling on feeding for malnourished children between 2 to 5 years
- Immunization

Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy Maternity Benefit Scheme

This scheme is being implemented in Tamil Nadu with a noble objective of providing financial assistance to poor pregnant mothers to meet expenses on nutritious diet, to compensate for the loss of income during motherhood and to avoid low birth weight of new born babies. In this scheme, Rs. 12,000 per beneficiary is given from 20 Feb 2017, it is increased to Rs. 18000 for the improvement of healthy motherhood.

Amma Baby care kit

This is launched in Tamil Nadu in the year 2015. Under this scheme, all the babies born in Government institutions are given Amma Baby Care Kit worth of Rs.1,000/-. It is distributed with the objective of improving the hygiene of the postnatal mothers and the newborn baby and inculcating hygienic practices among the mothers for self and baby care. The Amma Baby Care kit contains 16 items viz. baby towel, baby dress, baby bed, baby protective net, baby napkin, baby oil, baby shampoo, baby soap, baby soap box, baby nail clipper, baby rattle, baby toy, liquid hand wash, bathing soap, sowbagyasundilehiyam and a kit bag to securely keep all the items.

Activity 1

Go to nearby Primary Health centre and observe the Immunization process and cold chain systems followed and write a report.

Go to nearby ICDS centre and ask for the growth chart of the children. Study in detail the growth chart and write a report.

SUMMARY

- A newborn otherwise known as a "neonate" is a child under 28 days of age.
- The period between birth to first 28 days is known as neonatal period.
- The APGAR score is taken at 1 minute and again at 5 minutes after birth.
- It requires immediate and careful observation of the Appearance, Pulse, Grimace, Activity and Respiration.
- Heat is lost from the newborn by four ways such as convection, radiation, conduction and evaporation.
- The first milk which is called "colostrum" is the most suitable food for the baby during early period because it is rich in anti-infective factors.
- Immunization is a mass means of protecting the greatest number of people

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